

Algorithmic choice relocates power

Research questions plus data artifacts collected (no results yet).

NO RESULTS TODAY

Algorithmic choice does not remove power - it relocates it.
Meeting focus: prioritize RQs and define what to recollect next.



System framing: pluggable services, new chokepoints

Takeaway: modular services relocate concentration.



Discovery surfaces and provider hosting are key chokepoints.



Bluesky UI: feed marketplace (/feeds)

Takeaway: feeds are discoverable + selectable algorithmic timelines.

A. /feeds directory

Search feeds

B. Feed cards

Creator + likes

C. Trending widget

Defaults matter

Discovery risk



Bluesky UI: what a feed looks like

Takeaway: a feed page renders an algorithm into a timeline of posts.

A. Feed name

Demand signals

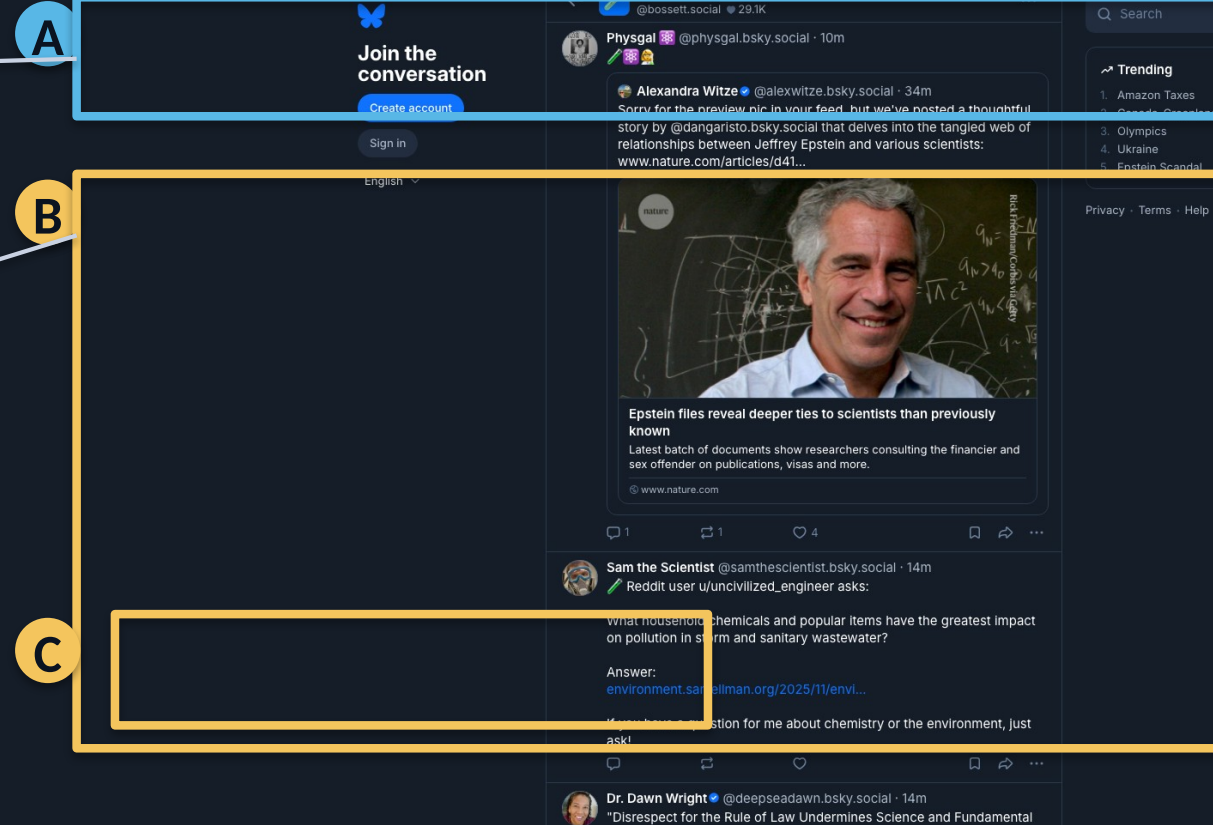
B. Timeline output

Exposure decisions

C. Post actions

Why we measure

Manipulation risk



Bluesky UI: starter packs (onboarding bundles)

Takeaway: starter packs bundle people (and sometimes feeds) for fast onboarding.

A. Pack title

Curated list

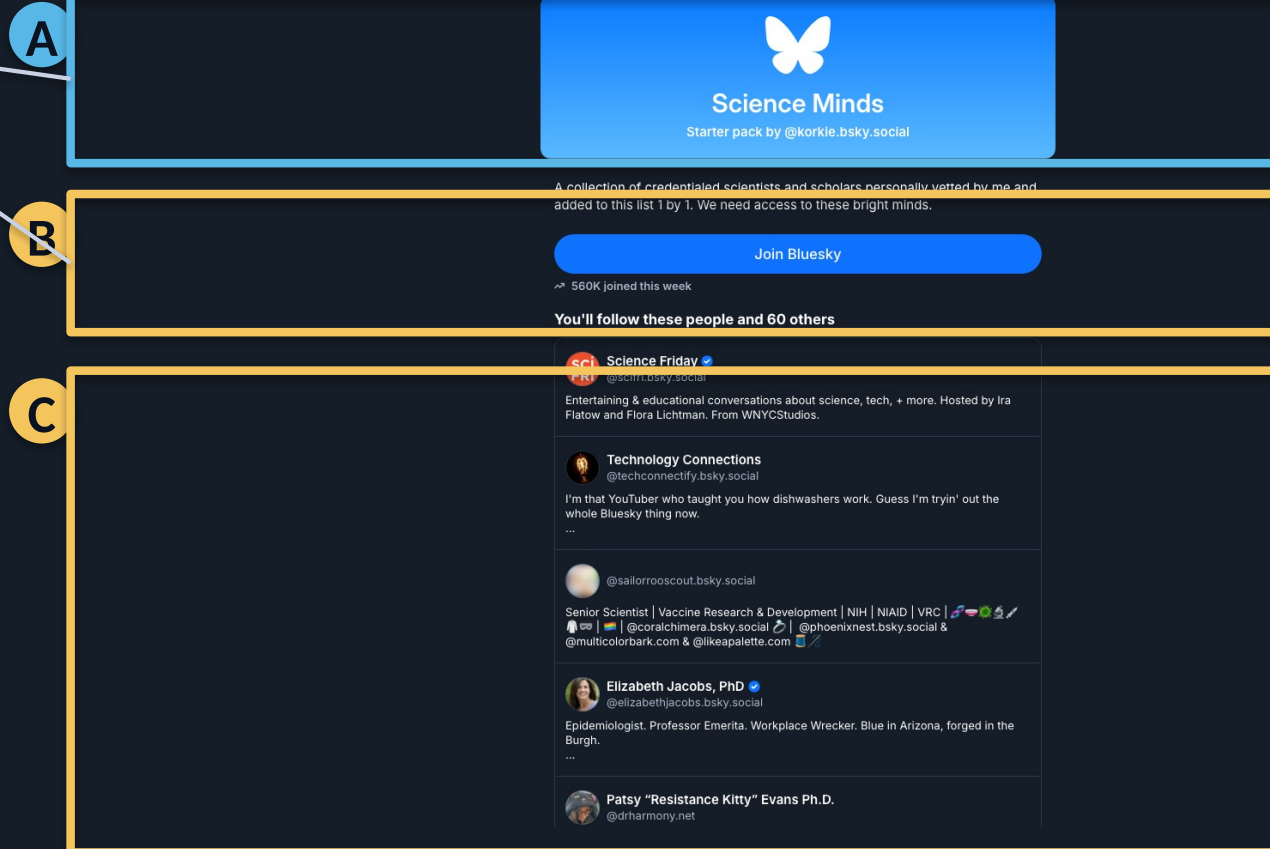
B. Join button

1-click onboarding

C. People cards

Curation questions

Measure exposure



Research questions (R1-R5)

Takeaway: security and privacy scope.

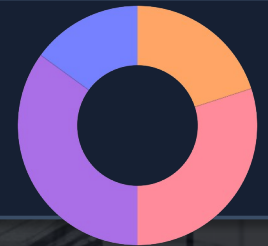
 R1 Discovery chokepoints? governance.

 R2 Provider buckets dominate? reliability.

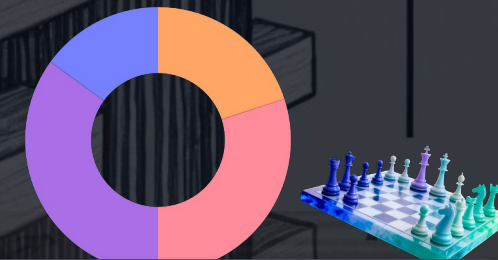
 R3 Same winners across feeds? manipulation.

 R4 Labels vary by viewer? safety.

 R5 Future experiment: gaming plus privacy attacks. extra guardrails.



Data artifacts collected (no results)



Discovery inputs

feed_generators_index.csv
starterpacks.csv
starterpack_feeds.csv
discovery_feed_inclusions.csv
popular_feeds.csv

Panel snapshots

feed_panel.csv
feed_items.csv.gz
posts.csv.gz
authors.csv.gz
post_labels.csv.gz

Trust and reproducibility

state.db
run_metadata.csv
run_summary.csv
manifest.csv
data_dictionary.csv
validation_report.csv

Join spine

feed_panel -> feed_items -> posts/authors
post_labels attaches by feed_uri, viewer_mode, post_uri, post_cid.
Result: joinable, reproducible, auditable artifacts.



Collection credibility (one slide)



Read-only XRPC summary

Relay + AppView reads.

GET-only in this run.

POST auth only if auth mode is used.

No posting actions.

7-stage pipeline

relay -> index -> packs -> popular -> enrich -> panel
-> snapshot

Reproducibility: state.db, manifest.csv,
data_dictionary.csv, validation_report.csv.



What this enables next + advisor asks



Ready measurements

- RQ1: measure discovery concentration.
- RQ2: map provider leverage.
- RQ3: test same winner overlap.
- RQ4: compare label variability.

What I need from you

- Ask 1: priority RQs and venue fit.
- Ask 2: recollect longitudinal, auth mode, or experiments?

